

The Collective at Raipur. It is a multi-brand luxury fashion retail concept operated by Aditya Birla Fashion and Retail



after-sales infrastructure. We are seeing opportunities across emerging markets, and our network expansion strategy will increasingly focus on Tier-II and Tier-III cities," says brand director Balbir Singh Dhillon. He points to encouraging demand in Surat and Kochi and opportunities in Raipur, Nashik and Kanpur. "Buyers in emerging markets are becoming more discerning. We are also seeing interest in performance-oriented models such as Audi SQ8 and Audi RS Q8, demonstrating the appeal of combining everyday usability with performance and distinctive design," says Dhillon.

## PRIVATE CLUBS AND FINE DINING

When the Indian Hotels Company Ltd opened the 181-room Taj Palace Lucknow in August 2026, it came as no surprise. The city, which already has the Taj Mahal hotel, has expanded enough to accommodate another luxury hotel. But the surprise was the introduction of The Chambers, Taj Hotels' exclusive, invitation-only private business club. IHCL operates The Chambers at Mumbai, Delhi, Bangalore, Chennai, Hyderabad, and Kolkata, making Lucknow the first Tier-II city for The Chambers. Santosh Shetty, the general manager, says it has drawn strong interest from business families, industrialists, entrepreneurs and high-net-worth individuals. The annual fee runs into several lakh rupees.

The club will offer a dedicated lounge, private dining and boardroom facilities. Shetty sees demand for exclusive venues that combine business networking, entertainment and discretion. Keeping in mind expansion of luxury retail into Tier-II cities, the hotel has also received interest from prospective Indian and international luxury retail partners.

Taj Palace's House of Ming provides another indication of local demand. According to Shetty, the restaurant runs at approximately 75% occupancy on weekdays and 90% on weekends, with repeat visits from local patrons. The hotel estimates an average meal for two at about ₹5,000.

Across fashion, hospitality and cars, the businesses' strategies differ, but their investments point to the same conclusion: luxury purchasing power extends beyond the places where luxury retail first established itself in India. BT